AI Ethics

Correct AI Usage in College Paragraph:

AI usage in college is a complicated subject because while AI is an incredibly powerful tool that it is important to be well versed in, reliance on it can detract from the quality of your education. AI should be used to make your learning process more efficient, but not to replace work you need to do to learn. For example, using AI to create a study plan, practice problems, practice exams, or quizzes to help you study is a very beneficial use, as this streamlines your learning process without replacing actual work that has to be done. In contrast, using AI to do homework, quizzes, projects, or tests is a bad usage of it because that replaces the core curriculum that teaches a student how to think.

Gemini Response when asked if it agreed (10/29):

Yes, that is a well-balanced and accurate perspective on AI in higher education. The paragraph effectively captures the critical distinction between using AI as a **learning accelerator** versus an **intellectual shortcut**.

Here is why that breakdown hits the mark:

- **Emphasizes AI Literacy:** Acknowledging that students need to know how to use AI reflects reality. Blanket bans are rarely effective or practical, and mastering AI tools is an increasingly important skill for the modern workforce.
- **Preserves Core Cognitive Development:** The main purpose of assignments, essays, and problem sets isn't just to generate a final answer—it's to build critical thinking, retention, problem-solving, and analytical capabilities. Outsourcing that effort to an AI bypasses the actual learning mechanism.
- **Distinguishes Active vs. Passive Use:**
    - **Positive Usage (Study Partner):** Generating flashcards, explaining tricky concepts in different ways, or building practice quizzes uses AI to enhance active recall and study efficiency.
    - **Negative Usage (Ghostwriter/Proxy):** Having AI draft essays or solve homework assignments directly undermines skill acquisition and often violates academic integrity policies.

It strikes a pragmatic middle ground: treat AI like an interactive tutor or study assistant, not a replacement for your own thinking.

Incorrect AI Usage in College Paragraph:
Incorrect AI Usage in college entails using AI to replace your education simply to achieve good grades. Fundamentally, the objective of going to college is to learn a variety of things including domain knowledge and critical thinking skills. While AI can at this point effectively complete most assignments for most courses, just using it to achieve a good grade ignores the fundamental point of an education, which is to improve your own skills and thinking. Students who use AI to complete as much of the coursework as possible will be left helpless during exams, job interviews, and actual work, which is why using it in this regard is extremely detrimental.

Gemini Response when asked if it agreed (10/29):

Yes, the paragraph makes a strong, valid point about the dangers of using AI as an intellectual crutch in college.

Here is why that perspective aligns with the realities of modern education and the job market:

- **Separates Credentials from Capability:** Getting a good grade by outsourcing your work to AI creates an illusion of competence. A degree might get your resume viewed, but technical interviews, on-the-spot problem solving, and actual job performance will quickly expose a lack of underlying knowledge.
- **Identifies the Real Risk (Unpreparedness):** Highlighting that students will be left helpless during proctored exams, interviews, and real-world tasks is accurate. When you skip the struggle of working through complex assignments, you fail to build the neural pathways required for critical thinking and skill retention.
- **Addresses the Intent of Higher Education:** The core purpose of university isn't just to produce a piece of paper or a high GPA—it's to condition your brain to analyze, synthesize, and solve novel problems. Using AI to bypass that friction directly defeats the purpose of attending college in the first place.

While the paragraph focuses primarily on the **negative usage pattern** (using AI strictly as a shortcut to bypass learning), its main premise is sound: prioritizing temporary grades over long-term skill acquisition is a self-defeating strategy.